

May

9

1950

Smokey Bear

During a forest fire in New Mexico, USA, firefighters rescued a bear cub with burnt legs and paws clinging to a tree. Nicknamed Smokey Bear, the cub went on to become a famous icon for forest fire prevention.



Also on this day

1901 The first Parliament of the Commonwealth of Australia was opened at a grand ceremony in Melbourne by the UK's Prince George, who later became King George V.

1950 French foreign minister Robert Schuman suggested European powers produce coal and steel jointly so that they would be less likely to go to war again. This was the first step towards the creation of the European Union (EU) many years later.

Dinosaur eggs

Scientists studying a nest of 90-million-year-old fossilized dinosaur eggs found in China in 1993 named the species *Beibeilong sinensis*, meaning “baby dragon from China”. It was a giant feathered dinosaur.



2017

Enigma machine

The British Royal Navy captured a German submarine, from which it recovered one of the Enigma machines used by the Nazis to turn secret German messages to unreadable codes during World War II. British code breakers would eventually learn how to read the codes.



Born this day

1921 **Sophie Scholl**, German student activist. She was a member of White Rose, a non-violent, anti-Nazi resistance group. Scholl was executed in 1943 at the age of 21.

1979 **Rosario Dawson**, US actor. She co-founded Voto Latino, an organization that encourages young Hispanic people to vote.